

SpaceX Starship flight 9 delayed after explosion



SpaceX's highly anticipated ninth Starship test flight was abruptly pushed back in early May after a catastrophic explosion at the Starbase facility in Texas. The

explosion, which occurred during a critical pre-launch test, destroyed the test vehicle and pushed back the launch schedule. Starship is central to SpaceX's vision for deep space exploration, including future missions to the Moon and Mars. Despite the glitch, the rapid test-and-learn strategy of SpaceX is still in the driver's seat of commercial spaceflight innovation, and the world awaits the next step for this program that dares to dream big.

Most powerful solar flare of 2025 hits hard

Mid-May saw the sun unleash its strongest solar flare of 2025, an X-class flare, causing radio blackouts and disrupting air and sea communications in Europe, Asia, and the Middle East. Geomagnetic storms from the flare also impacted satellite systems and power grids.



As the sun nears its solar maximum, researchers are calling for more space weather forecasting to guard against critical infrastructure. The event is a reminder of the ever-present susceptibility of contemporary technology to solar activity and the requirement of global monitoring initiatives.

Europe's Proba-3 satellites complete milestone

In May, the European Space Agency's Proba-3 mission achieved a milestone in precision formation flight, with two satellites maintaining a steady 150-meter separation. These satellites, forming a giant space-based coronagraph, will study the sun's corona. This

success marks a leap in autonomous spacecraft coordination, enabling future missions involving multiple satellites flying in close formation. The technology is key to advanced solar research, exoplanet discovery, and building modular space telescopes.

NISAR: NASA-ISRO's Earth mission set for June launch

After years of delays, NASA-ISRO's NISAR mission will launch in June 2025 on ISRO's GSLV-F16 rocket. It uses dual-frequency radar to detect surface changes. Scanning nearly all land and ice every 12 days, it will provide vital data on earthquakes and climate change. With a \$1.5 billion budget, NISAR is one of the costliest Earth-imaging satellites and offers open data for researchers worldwide.

Indian astronaut to fly historic ISS mission

Indian Air Force Group Captain Shubhanshu Shukla will be the first Indian to visit the International Space Station, second in space after Rakesh Sharma. His Ax-4 mission with Axiom Space



launches June 8, 2025, aboard SpaceX Dragon on Falcon 9. He will conduct scientific and Gaganyaan-related experiments, marking a new chapter in India's space ambitions.